

Alpha Burritos

Alpha Burritos is a modern, interactive React application developed for CERN's ALPHA experiment. It provides researchers and analysts with a user-friendly interface to browse, visualize, and analyze signal data from the experiment's "burrito detectors"—specialized detection systems that capture antimatter annihilation events.

The application communicates with a custom RESTful API to fetch and display critical data, including JSON parameter files and detector-specific PNG images captured at various timestamps. By consolidating multiple data streams into a single, responsive interface, Alpha Burritos simplifies the complex task of antimatter detection analysis and monitoring.

ALPHA

ALPHA Burrito Detectors

System Status

Expert Mode: ON

acquisition: stopped

analysis: stopped

temperature: running

LOG OUT

acquisition

analysis

temperature

START

STOP

START

STOP

START

STOP

Offline analysis configuration

POSITRONS

ANTIPROTONS

FIT ENABLED

RE-ANALYSE

SHOW DETAILS

GO TO THE GUIDE

Latest acquisition: 2026-03-14 17:25:35 - From the positrons trigger

Data selection

Auto-refresh

Year: 2026

Month: 3

Day: 16

Timestamp: 2026-03-16 16:26:05

Detector: PDS

Antiprotons - 2026-03-16 16:26:05

Detector: PDS

Location	Area [V·ns]	FWHM [ns]	Peak [mV]	Rise [ns]	Time Peak [ns]	Interval [ns]	Arrival [ns]
PDS	0.451	87.4	6.70	43.7	5.18e+3	8.00	5.11e+3
LDS	7.41	102	55.2	219	760	8.00	524
USAT	11.7	122	77.0	87.4	760	8.00	656
DSAT	0.00	87.4	-1.52	0.00	1.08e+5	8.00	1.08e+5
BDS	4.87	43.7	43.5	481	624	8.00	131
PMT11	0.00	87.4	-1.34	0.00	1.28e+5	8.00	1.28e+5
USCT	24.3	1.03e+3	24.2	699	992	8.00	262
DSCT	39.9	722	52.1	350	1.11e+3	8.00	699
UDS	19.4	699	37.8	67.4	608	8.00	524
Scope	0.00	87.4	1.70	0.00	4.18e+4	8.00	4.18e+4

No comment

SHARE LINK

REVERSE TABLE

UPDATE COMMENTS

DOWNLOAD SIGNAL (.TXT)

PDS

peak time: 5184.0 ns

Area = 0.5 V ns

10 mV

10 ns

1. peak: 1234 ns

Ref: 87.4 ns

10 mV

10 ns

1. peak: 760 ns

Ref: 102.0 ns

10 mV

10 ns

1. peak: 760 ns

Ref: 122.0 ns

10 mV

10 ns

1. peak: 127648 ns

Ref: 87.4 ns

10 mV

10 ns

1. peak: 524 ns

Ref: 43.7 ns

10 mV

10 ns

1. peak: 128136 ns

Ref: 87.4 ns

10 mV

10 ns

1. peak: 992 ns

Ref: 1030.0 ns

10 mV

10 ns

1. peak: 112 ns

Ref: 722.0 ns

10 mV

10 ns

1. peak: 109 ns

Ref: 69.9 ns

10 mV

10 ns

1. peak: 41808 ns

Ref: 87.4 ns

COMBINED PLOT

DOWNLOAD ALL (.TXT)

Skimmer

Particle: Antiprotons

Detector: PDS

Acquisition timestamp: 2026-03-16 16:26:05

Acquisition timestamp: 2026-03-16 16:26:05

Last N acquisitions

N: 4

Timestamps	Area [V·ns]	FWHM [ns]	Peak [mV]	Rise [ns]	Time Peak [ns]	Interval [ns]	Arrival [ns]
2026-03-16 16:18:10	0.00	87.4	3.60	0.00	1.02e+5	8.00	1.02e+5
2026-03-16 16:20:09	0.541	87.4	6.62	43.7	1.09e+3	8.00	1.01e+3
2026-03-16 16:24:06	3.04	103	25.1	87.4	1.50e+3	8.00	1.40e+3
2026-03-16 16:26:05	0.451	87.4	6.70	43.7	5.18e+3	8.00	5.11e+3
Mean	1.01	91.3	10.5	43.7	2.75e+4	8.00	2.74e+4

DOWNLOAD THE SUMMARY (.CSV)

Features

- Temperature Monitoring:** View real-time temperature readings from multiple detector hosts (pitaya boards) in a compact, color-coded table. The temperature data is fetched from the backend and auto-refreshes every 10 seconds. The table uses a green background to match the application's button style.

- **Year/Month/Day Selection:** Choose the year, month, and day to filter available data files.
- **Timestamp Selection:** Select a specific acquisition timestamp from available JSON files.
- **Parameter Display:** View key parameters (area, FWHM, peak, rise, time peak, dt, arrival) for each detector.
- **Combined Image View:** See the combined detector image for the selected acquisition.
- **Detector Selection:** Choose a specific detector (PDS, BDS, DSAT, USAT, PMT11, etc.) to view its processed image.
- **Signal Download:** Download the raw signal as a text file for the selected detector and timestamp.
- **Download All Signals:** Download signal files for all available detectors at once.
- **Comments:** Add and edit comments for specific acquisition files.
- **Auto-Refresh:** Automatically refresh the list of available files.
- **Skimmer:** Browse and export a range of acquisitions and parameters as CSV.
- **Responsive UI:** Built with React and styled for clarity and usability.
- **Authentication:** Secure login for authorized users.
- **Choose Configuration:** Select the analysis mode ("positrons" or "antiprotons") and toggle the fit option for the current session.
- **Re-analyse:** Trigger a new analysis of the currently selected file with the current configuration.

Project Structure

```
src/
  main.jsx           # React entry point
  main.css           # Global styles
  app/
    App.jsx          # Main React component
    LoginForm.jsx     # User authentication form
    MainTitle.jsx     # App title and logo
    MessageAlert.jsx  # Reusable alert/message component
  assets/
    ALPHA_Logo_png.png # ALPHA experiment logo
  configuration/
    ChooseConfiguration.jsx # Select analysis mode
                           (positrons/antiprotons) and fit option
    ConfigTable.jsx     # Displays configuration details in a
table
    dataDisplay/
      DataDisplay.jsx   # Container for detector data
  visualization
    DetectorImage.jsx   # Shows image for a selected detector
    DetectorImageAll.jsx # Shows combined detector image (all
detectors)
    DownloadButton.jsx  # Button to download the signal as a
text file
    DownloadAllButton.jsx # Button to download all signals for
all detectors
    Parameters.jsx      # Displays detector parameters from
JSON
    Skimmer.jsx         # Browse and export a range of
acquisitions as CSV
```

```
dataSelection/  
  AutoRefresh.jsx          # Toggle auto-refresh of file list  
  DataSelection.jsx        # Container for data selection controls  
  DateSelector.jsx         # Dropdowns for year/month/day  
selection  
  DetectorSelector.jsx     # Dropdown for detector selection  
  TimestampSelector.jsx    # Dropdown for timestamp/file selection  
systemStatus/  
  SystemStatus.jsx        # System status panel with expert-mode  
controls  
  TemperatureDisplay.jsx   # Real-time temperature readings for  
detector hosts  
  WorkerMonitor.jsx       # Monitors Python worker process status
```

How It Works

1. **Select Year/Month/Day:**

Use the dropdowns to pick a year, month, and day. The app fetches available JSON files for that period.

2. **Select Timestamp:**

Choose a file (timestamp) from the dropdown. The app loads its parameters and images.

3. **View Parameters:**

The **Parameters** panel displays key values for each detector.

4. **View Images:**

- An image containing subplots (one signal per subplot) is shown by default.
- Use the "Combined plot" button to switch to a single plot with all signals overlaid.
- Use the detector dropdown to view images for individual detectors.

5. **Download Signals:**

- Use the "Download the signal" button to download the raw signal for the selected detector.
- Use the "Download the signals" button to download signals for all available detectors at once.

6. **Add Comments:**

Add notes or observations about specific acquisition files for collaborative research.

7. **Auto-Refresh:**

Enable auto-refresh to automatically update the list of available files every 2 seconds.

8. **Skimmer:**

Use the Skimmer tool to select a range of acquisitions, view their parameters in tabular form, and export as CSV.

9. **Authentication:**

Login is required to access the main features. Credentials are checked via the backend API.

10. Choose Configuration:

Use the "Choose configuration" panel to select the analysis mode ("positrons" or "antiprotons") and toggle the fit option for the current session.

11. Re-analyse:

Use the "Re-analyse" button to trigger a new analysis of the currently selected file with the current configuration.

API Endpoints

The React app expects the following backend API (see `server.js`):

- **Test if the API is working:**

GET `/api/test`

- Returns a JSON file to confirm that the API is working.
- Example: `/api/test`
- Response:

```
{ "message": "API is working" }
```

- **List JSON Files:**

GET `/api/:year/:month/:day/json`

- Returns a list of JSON filenames for the specified year, month, and day.
- Example: `/api/2025/06/02/json`
- Response:

```
["data-2025-06-02_08-25-03.json", "file-2025-06-02.json"]
```

- **Get JSON File Content:**

GET `/api/json/:jsonFilename`

- Returns the parsed JSON content of the specified file.
- Example: `/api/json/data-2025-06-02_08-25-03.json`
- Response:

```
{ "PDS": { "area": ..., ... }, ... }
```

- **Get Combined Image (single plot, all signals):**

GET `/api/Together/:imageName`

- Returns the PNG image with all signals overlaid in a single plot (from the `Together` subdirectory).

- Example: `/api/Together/data-2025-06-02_08-25-03.png`
- Response:
Binary PNG image.

- **Get Subplots Image (default):**

`GET /api/Same/:imageName`

- Returns the PNG image containing subplots (one signal per subplot) for all signals (from the `Same` subdirectory).
- Example: `/api/Same/data-2025-06-02_08-25-03.png`
- Response:
Binary PNG image.

- **Get Detector-Specific Image:**

`GET /api/img/:detector/:imageName`

- Returns the PNG image for a specific detector.
- Example: `/api/img/PDS/data-2025-06-02_08-25-03.png`
- Response:
Binary PNG image.

- **Get Detector-Specific Signal:**

`GET /api/signal/:detector/:jsonFilename`

- Returns the signal as a text file for a specific detector and JSON file.
- Example: `/api/signal/PDS/data-2025-06-02_08-25-03.json`
- Response:
Text file

- **Get Detector-Specific Signal (CSV):**

`GET /api/signal/csv/:detector/:jsonFilename`

- Returns the signal as a CSV file for a specific detector and JSON file.
- Example: `/api/signal/csv/PDS/data-2025-06-02_08-25-03.json`
- Response:
CSV file

- **Get Comments:**

`GET /api/comments/:jsonFilename`

- Retrieves any saved comments for a specific JSON file.
- Example: `/api/comments/data-2025-06-02_08-25-03.json`
- Response:

```
{ "comment": "This detection shows interesting peak values." }
```

- Returns `{ "comment": null }` if no comment exists.

- **Post Comments:**

`POST /api/comments/:jsonFilename`

- Saves a comment for a specific JSON file.
- Example: `/api/comments/data-2025-06-02_08-25-03.json`
- Request Body:

```
{ "comment": "This detection shows interesting peak values." }
```

- Response:

```
{ "success": true, "message": "Comment updated successfully" }
```

- **Get/Update Configuration:**

- `GET /api/configuration` — Get the current configuration (from `ANALYSIS_DIR/configurations/configuration.json`).
- `POST /api/configuration` — Update the configuration (expects JSON body).

- **Get the Latest Dump Timestamp:**

`GET /api/latest`

- Returns the latest dump timestamp.
- Example: `/api/latest`
- Response:

```
{ "latest": "2025-08-25_11-04-04" }
```

- **Re-analyse a JSON File:**

`GET /api/reanalyse/:filename`

- Triggers a re-analysis for the specified JSON file.

- **Check Python Worker Status:**

`GET /api/status/:pidfile`

- Checks if a Python worker process is running, based on the given pidfile name.
- Example: `/api/status/worker`
- Response:

```
{ "worker": "running" }
```

or

```
{ "worker": "stopped" }
```

- **Authentication:**

- `POST /api/login` — Authenticate user (expects { `login`, `password` } in body).
- `GET /api/profile` — Returns user info if authenticated.
- `POST /api/logout` — Logout user and clear authentication cookie.

- **Start a Python Worker Script (requires authentication):**

`POST /api/start/:name`

- Starts a Python worker script in the background. Allowed names: `acquisition`, `analysis`, `temperature`.
- Example: `/api/start/acquisition`
- Response:

```
{ "success": true, "script": "START_ACQUISITION.py", "pid": 12345 }
```

- Returns `409` with { `"error": "acquisition is already running"` } if already running.

- **Stop a Python Worker Script (requires authentication):**

`POST /api/stop/:name`

- Stops a running Python worker script. Allowed names: `acquisition`, `analysis`, `temperature`.
- Example: `/api/stop/analysis`
- Response:

```
{ "success": true, "script": "ONLINE_ANALYSIS.py", "pid": 12345 }
```

- Returns { `"success": true, "message": "analysis is not running"` } if not running.

- **Get Temperature Data:**

`GET /api/temperature`

- Returns the latest temperature readings for all detector hosts.
- Example: `/api/temperature`
- Response:

```
{  
  "hosts": {  
    "rp-f0a821.local": { "temp_c": 41.59, "error": null },  
  }  
}
```

```
    "rp-f073bf.local": { "temp_c": 42.82, "error": null }  
  },  
  "timestamp_utc": "2025-10-08 08:42:16"  
}
```

Error Handling

- Returns 404 if a file or image is not found.
- Returns 400 for invalid requests.
- Returns 500 for server errors.

Directory Structure

The API expects files to be organized as:

```
MAIN_DIR/  
  YYYY/  
    MM/  
      DD/  
        JSON/  
          data-YYYY-MM-DD.json  
          comments.json  
        Together/  
          data-YYYY-MM-DD.png  
        Same/  
          data-YYYY-MM-DD.png  
        PDS/  
          data-YYYY-MM-DD.png  
          data-YYYY-MM-DD.txt  
        BDS/  
          data-YYYY-MM-DD.png  
          data-YYYY-MM-DD.txt  
        ...
```

Development

Prerequisites

- Node.js (v18+ recommended)
- npm

Install dependencies

```
npm install
```

Start the React App

Development mode:

```
npm run dev
```

The app will be available at <http://localhost:5173> by default.

For production deployments, it is recommended to use a web server such as **NGINX** to serve the built frontend.

See the [NGINX documentation](#) for setup instructions and configuration examples.

Start the Backend API

You have two options:

Option 1: Run directly with Node.js (recommended for development):

```
node server.js
```

Option 2: Run with PM2 (recommended for production):

```
# Start the server
pm2 start server.js --name burritos

# Save the process list
pm2 save

# Set up PM2 to start on system boot
pm2 startup

# Follow the instructions and run the command output by the previous step
```

- View logs: `pm2 logs burritos`
- Stop the server: `pm2 stop burritos`
- Restart the server: `pm2 restart burritos`

The API will be available at <http://localhost:3001> by default.

Customization

- **API URL:**

If your backend runs on a different host or port, update the API URLs in the React components (e.g.,

`Parameters.jsx`, `DetectorImage.jsx`, etc.).

- **Data Directory and Environment Variables:**

The backend expects data in a specific directory structure (see API documentation above).

The main directory of the data and other sensitive configuration must be declared in a `.env` file at the project root.

Example `.env` file:

```
MAIN_DIR=/absolute/path/to/your/data
ANALYSIS_DIR=/absolute/path/to/your/analysis
PORT=3001
USER_LOGIN=your_login
USER_PASSWORD_HASH=your_bcrypt_hash
JWT_SECRET=your_jwt_secret
PYTHON_PATH=/usr/bin/python3
```

- **MAIN_DIR**: Absolute path to the main data directory (required).
- **ANALYSIS_DIR**: Absolute path to the analysis directory (required).
- **PORT**: Port for the backend server (default: 3001).
- **USER_LOGIN**: Username for authentication (required).
- **USER_PASSWORD_HASH**: Bcrypt hash of the password for authentication (required).
- **JWT_SECRET**: Secret key for JWT authentication (required).
- **PYTHON_PATH**: Path to the Python executable used for analysis scripts. If not specified, defaults to `python3`.

Note: Never commit your `.env` file to version control as it may contain sensitive information.

Useful Resources

- [React Documentation](#)
- [Vite Documentation](#)
- [Express Documentation](#)
- [Node.js Documentation](#)
- [PM2 documentation](#)
- [NGINX Documentation](#)
- [JavaScript Reference \(MDN\)](#)
- [JSON Format](#)
- [RESTful API Design](#)
- [GitHub Guides](#)
- [ALPHA Experiment \(CERN\)](#)

This project uses React, Vite, and Express. For backend API details, see `server.js`.

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